BREAD OF LIFE
FEED • SHELTER • EMPOWER
FALL 2026 EDITION

Honoring Leadership: The North Star Award

> *"A leader always sets the trail for others to follow. Know the way. Go the way. Show the way."*
>
> — The North Star Motto

Leadership at Bread of Life means guiding individuals through some of the most challenging moments of their lives toward safety, dignity, and independence. We are thrilled to announce the presentation of the **2026 North Star Award** to **Brad Truman**!

The North Star Award is presented to individuals who serve as a constant anchor and guide for our organization, staff, and shelter residents. Brad's steady leadership, hands-on dedication, and ongoing guidance serve as a beacon for those navigating the transition from crisis to long-term stability across Kennebec County.



Brad Truman (center) receiving the North Star Award plaque and glass compass trophy alongside leadership.

Significance of the North Star Award

- **Guiding Compass:** Honors steady leaders who keep team members and shelter guests focused on their journey toward housing and recovery.
- **Permanent Recognition:** Honored with a custom engraved glass star award and an official placement on the Bread of Life North Star plaque.

Staff Appreciation & Community Team Building

Behind every meal served and every veteran housed is a team that cares deeply. We recently celebrated **Bread of Life Staff Appreciation Day** with outdoor games, team building, and lots of smiles along the Kennebec River! Special highlights included our staff cornhole tournament champions and a shoutout to dedicated team members like Willie in our soup kitchen.



Cornhole Tournament Trophy Winners!



Staff day celebration & team unity.

Empowering Veterans: The Vets Inc. Initiative

Through specialized partnerships like the **Vets Inc. program**, Bread of Life connects unhoused veterans with transitional housing, healthcare support, employment training, and clinical case management. Program participants like Patrick — a U.S. Army veteran who overcame severe hardship, addiction, and homelessness — demonstrate the transformative impact of compassionate, individualized support.

Executive Director Victoria Abbott emphasized: *"We are looking at the person: what they need, where they come from, and the next steps that will work best."* In July alone, our programs served over 4,465 meals, assisted 68 shelter guests, and helped 15 individuals transition into permanent housing.

Join Us in Making a Difference

Donate, volunteer, or learn more at **mainebreadoflife.org** | Call (207) 626-3434